BROOKLYN COMMUNITY BOARD 6
LANDMARKS/LAND USE & HOUSING COMMITTEE
December 5, 2024

Attendees:
David Briggs - Chair
Jerry Armer
Daniel Kummer
Catherine Vaughn

Quorum not present.

Landmarks

43 Sterling Place (Park Slope Historic District Extension II) - Legalize replacing bluestone with tinted concrete sidewalk without LPC permits

Presentation made by the owner. She received a notice from her insurance carrier that her existing bluestone sidewalk must be repaired since it presented a tripping hazard. She hired a contractor and contacted the DOT who issued a permit. She misunderstood that she was also supposed to get LPC approval.

Questions/Comments from committee:
1. Did DOT indicate that she needed an LPC permit? They did not.
2. She confirmed with photos that the sidewalk at 41 Sterling is bluestone and the sidewalk at 45 Sterling is untinted concrete.

Jerry - recommended approval
Daniel - seconded

Recommendation passed 4-0. A formal motion will be made at the December 11 board meeting.

Land Use

DEP presentation: Construction Update for the Combined Sewer Overflow at the Head End Site Facility (north end of the canal). There have been some complaints regarding odors during the excavation of the 200’ deep cut off wall around the perimeter of the tanks. Approx. 50% of the complaints have been from the same caller. In order to reduce the impact of the odors, DEP presented an accelerated remediation timeline and

other strategies, including capping the excavations with foam and trapping the odors in a vent, similar to CO2 scrubbers. The accelerated timeline targets March 2025 for completion of excavation.

The committee and community asked several questions.
- Why was EPA pushing back on the accelerated schedule?
- Have any harmful vapors/compounds been identified in the air monitoring? DEP indicated that EPA should answer this question.
- Where can the results of the monitoring be found? DEP will provide.
- Who should people contact if they have immediate concerns? DEP will provide.
- Is the overall project on schedule? The project is currently a few months behind schedule, but the accelerated timeline will help close the gap.

Daniel - Motion to support accelerated timeline and committee encourages DEP to continue pursuing strategies for reducing odors. Request to continue updating the community on progress and providing all relevant data to the public.
Jerry - seconded

Recommendation passed 4-0.
A formal motion will be made at the December 11 board meeting.

The next day DEP provided the following information regarding the monitoring and contact info for the construction liaison:
https://www.nyc.gov/site/dep/water/gowanus-canal.page
Use the dropdown tab for “Superfund.” The air monitoring reports include a summary, which is helpful. Right now, the air sampling data is a spreadsheet (this is what EPA directed us to post), but we are thinking about how to make that more understandable.

Community Construction Liaison

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End of meeting.